

Fourteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Year A

PC-S38-A

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	<i>Cf. Ps. 48:10–11; mercy in the Temple</i>
Collect	<i>Deus, qui in Filii tui humilitate. . .</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	Zech. 9:9–10
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 145:1–2, 8–9, 10–11, 13–14; A: <i>cf. Ps. 145:1</i> ; B: <i>Alleluia</i>
Second Reading	Rom. 8:9, 11–13
Gospel Acclamation	<i>Cf. Matt. 11:25</i>
Gospel	Matt. 11:25–30
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over Offerings	<i>Oblatio nos. . . tuo nomini dicata purificet</i>
Communion Antiphon	A: Ps. 34:9; taste and refuge; B: Matt. 11:28; the burdened invited
Prayer after Communion	<i>Tantis. . . repleti muneribus</i>

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Zion receives a humble king; Israel praises the gracious sovereign; Paul commands Spirit-enabled mortification; Jesus reveals the Father and calls the burdened to his meek yoke.
Allegorical	Jesus is the promised King whose peace comes through humility. His risen Spirit dwells in his members, and Eucharistic Communion joins them to the Son who reveals the Father.
Moral	Become little enough to receive revelation; reject self-salvation and bodily contempt; put sinful deeds to death by the Spirit; take up Christ's teachable obedience.
Anagogical	Universal peace, resurrection through the indwelling Spirit, lasting joy, saving gifts, and promised rest disclose the kingdom's consummation.

Scriptural Date and Location

Canonical order governs; composition and narrated event remain distinct. Marked Cf. texts are adaptations, and dates orient rather than claim autograph precision.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
Communion A	Ps. 34:9	Kingdom of Israel; exact composition place unknown	Davidic attribution traditional; final date unknown
The inherited heading places David in flight from Saul; modern study cannot recover author, place, or date. Afflicted prayer becomes shared instruction in reverent trust; Communion A appoints one clause of that wisdom invitation.			
Entrance	Cf. Ps. 48:10–11	Jerusalem sanctuary in the poem’s cultic horizon; composition place unknown	Korahite attribution traditional; date unknown
Zion is the great King’s city and divine mercy is received in the Temple. The sons-of-Korah heading locates sanctuary tradition, not a recoverable autograph event. The Missal adapts Temple, mercy, praise, and worldwide horizon for the gathered Church.			
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 145:1–2, 8–9, 10–11, 13–14	Israel; exact place unknown	Davidic attribution traditional; likely late final form, date disputed
The alphabetic hymn praises God’s kingship through graciousness, compassion, fidelity, universal care, and support for the fallen. Davidic title and likely later shaping are distinct judgments. It answers the peaceful-king oracle while still addressing God directly.			
First Reading	Zech. 9:9–10	Judah and Jerusalem; exact collection place unknown	Postexilic period; final date of Zech. 9–14 disputed
The heading names Zechariah son of Berechiah in the Persian period. Modern Catholic study distinguishes undated chapters 9–14 from 1–8 and places their final form later; authorship and date remain debated. Daughter Zion receives a just, saving, humble king who removes war and extends peace to the nations.			
Acclamation / Gospel / Communion B	Cf. Matt. 11:25; Matt. 11:25–30; Matt. 11:28	Palestine in traditional attribution; Antioch in Syria plausible for the final Greek Gospel	Traditional early apostolic date; modern majority c. AD 80–90
Narrated event	Matt. 11:20–30	Galilee; exact place unrecorded	Public ministry, c. AD 28–29
Tradition: Matthew the Apostle to Jewish believers in Palestine. Modern majority: unknown final Greek author, after AD 70, often Antioch. After rebuking Galilean towns, Jesus thanks the Father for revelation to little ones, declares the Son’s unique knowledge and mediation, and calls the burdened to learn his meekness.			
Second Reading	Rom. 8:9, 11–13	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece)	c. AD 57
Paul addresses mixed Jewish and Gentile house churches at Rome near his eastern mission’s end. Spirit-governed life opposes disordered flesh and hopes for bodily resurrection. Lectionary 100 omits v. 10, then resumes with the Spirit who raised Jesus and the duty to mortify evil deeds.			

The Propers: Themes and Movement

Governing account

The officially correlated strand presents one royal paradox: God's reign arrives in a king whose strength is humble and whose yoke gives rest. Beside it, Romans continues its own apostolic course, locating Christian freedom in the Spirit who raises bodies and puts sinful deeds to death, while the offering and Communion texts carry these themes toward purification, salvation, and enduring praise.

Four-stage movement at a glance

- 1. Gathered by mercy — Entrance; Collect.** Temple mercy and the Son's humility gather and raise a fallen people.
- 2. The humble King speaks — First Reading; Psalm; Acclamation; Gospel.** Peaceful rule and filial revelation form the officially correlated strand without erasing each text's history.
- 3. Freedom under the Spirit — Second Reading.** Paul's semi-continuous strand calls hearers to Spirit-enabled mortification and bodily hope.
- 4. Purified, fed, praising — Prayer over Offerings; Communion; Prayer after Communion.** The appointed prayers and antiphons order disciples toward salvation and praise.

1. Mercy gathers those who cannot raise themselves (*Entrance; Collect*)

The Entrance begins with received mercy rather than religious achievement. Its Temple setting makes the gathering ecclesial, while praise reaches beyond one sanctuary. The Collect then attributes the world's raising to the Son's humility. These texts establish dependence before the readings specify kingship, Spirit, and discipleship; because they belong to Week XIV in every cycle, the relation is liturgical juxtaposition, not proved historical design.

2. Royal power takes the form of meekness (*First Reading; Psalm; Acclamation; Gospel*)

Zechariah removes the normal machinery of conquest from the king's arrival: humble riding, abolished weapons, peace proclaimed outward. Psalm 145 answers by praising the Lord whose kingdom is manifested through compassion, fidelity, and support. Matthew then gives the correlation its Christological center. Jesus does not merely recommend gentleness; as Son he reveals the Father, and as the meek teacher he summons disciples beneath his yoke.

3. Rest and mortification are not rivals (*Second Reading; Gospel*)

Romans remains a semi-continuous strand, yet it prevents sentimental readings of rest. The Spirit's indwelling generates obligation: evil deeds are to be put to death. Chrysostom and Augustine insist that this mortification concerns disordered action rather than hatred of the created body. The Gospel's light yoke likewise names obedient discipleship, not inactivity. Liturgical co-occurrence permits this qualified comparison without claiming that Paul was selected to explain Matthew.

4. Gift becomes purified life and enduring praise (*Prayer over Offerings; Communion; Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings asks that worship purify and redirect conduct. Communion Antiphon A stresses tasting and refuge; alternative B repeats Christ's invitation to the burdened. The final prayer asks that great gifts issue in salvation and unceasing praise, making reception a beginning of transformed life rather than a terminus.

Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

The peaceful king promised to Zion and the meek Son who reveals the Father disclose a form of divine rule in which power serves peace and authority teaches the burdened. Psalm 145 answers with praise of the gracious sovereign, so meekness appears as the exercise of faithful strength rather than its absence.

Romans gives this discipleship an interior and bodily depth. The Spirit who raised Jesus dwells in believers and enables them to put sinful deeds to death without treating the body itself as evil. Receptive littleness, Spirit-enabled obedience, and Christ's fitting yoke belong together as graced participation rather than self-salvation. The celebration looks toward universal peace, resurrection, saving reception, and enduring praise. Communion may voice either Psalm 34's invitation to taste and seek refuge or Christ's summons to the burdened; both paths direct the assembly toward life received from God and lived under the gentle kingship of the Son.

Dimension	Appointed anchors	Source-grounded synthesis	Limit
Christological	Zech. 9:9–10; Ps. 145; Matt. 11:25–30	Jesus discloses the peaceful King's power as filial revelation, meekness, and a yoke fitted by the Son who knows the Father.	The Lectionary officially correlates Zechariah and Matthew; it does not prove one historical composition or erase Zion's own horizon.
Pneumatological and anthropological	Rom. 8:9, 11–13	The indwelling Spirit joins belonging to Christ, mortification of sinful deeds, and hope for the life of mortal bodies.	Romans remains semi-continuous; flesh is not bodily substance, and the proclamation omits verse 10.
Ecclesial and sacramental	Entrance; Collect; Prayer over Offerings; Communion A/B; Prayer after Communion	A people gathered by mercy is raised through the Son's humility, purified in offering, fed through a real alternative Communion path, and ordered toward salvation and praise.	The Week XIV orations serve A/B/C, the Communion choice is unresolved, and no whole-formulary historical design is claimed.
Moral and eschatological	Gospel; Second Reading; Psalm; final prayer	Receptive littleness, meek strength, and Spirit-enabled obedience tend toward universal peace, bodily resurrection, salvation, and enduring praise.	Christ's yoke does not commend passivity before abuse, and promised rest is not present exemption from duty or suffering.

The Propers: Detailed Commentary

Received mercy and the humiliation that raises (*Entrance; Collect*)

Psalm 48's cultic geography is exacting: mercy is received *in the midst* of God's Temple, while praise extends to earth's ends. Gathering is neither private consolation nor possession of God by one place. The antiphon lets the Church enter as recipient and witness.

The Collect's Latin axis joins the Son's *humilitas*, a fallen world, release from sin's servitude, and enduring joy. Humility is therefore neither self-contempt nor mere style. It is first Christological: the Son descends and raises. Only then is it moral, because the raised people may share holy gladness.

A king without the instruments of domination (*First Reading; Responsorial Psalm*)

Zechariah 9:9–10 holds apparently contrary predicates together. The king is just and saving, yet humble; royal, yet riding the ordinary animal of peaceful entry; victorious, yet abolishing chariot, horse, and warrior's bow. His dominion from sea to sea is not an unlimited version of coercive empire. The text interprets its scope through the peace he proclaims to the nations.

The Christian reading does not cancel the oracle's address to Zion or Israel's hope. Matthew's passion narrative explicitly receives the entry image elsewhere, while this Sunday pairs the oracle with Jesus' self-identification as meek. That liturgical correlation warrants Christological fulfillment; it does not authorize contempt for the Jewish people or reduction of the first reading to a coded prediction with no original communal horizon.

Psalm 145 responds with a vocabulary of divine kingship that is ethical rather than merely titular. The Lord is gracious, compassionate, good to all, faithful, and near to those bowed down. The textual refrain names God as King; the authorized *Alleluia* response instead lets paschal praise frame the same verses. Neither changes the appointed strophes. The Psalm also qualifies human hopes: the assembly praises God as King while receiving the promised human royal figure in relation to him.

The Spirit's dwelling and the body's future (*Second Reading*)

Romans 8:9 locates Christian existence by indwelling: belonging to Christ is inseparable from the Spirit of Christ. After the appointed omission of verse 10, verse 11 grounds hope in the Spirit who raised Jesus and will give life to mortal bodies. The body is mortal and awaits vivification; it is not the evil that must be destroyed.

Verses 12–13 then announce an obligation without returning to self-salvation. Hearers are debtors, but not to disordered flesh as a ruling power. They must put evil deeds to death *by the Spirit*. Chrysostom's direct exposition treats the warning as real while distinguishing sinful deeds from bodily substance. Augustine likewise keeps divine aid and human action together. Grace neither ratifies passivity nor turns obedience into autonomous achievement.

The Lectionary's omission of verse 10 must remain visible. It creates a proclamation moving from Spirit-defined identity directly to resurrection and obligation. Commentary may consult the complete chapter, but it may not silently insert an unappointed verse or imply that worshippers heard it.

Revelation to the little and the yoke of the Son (*Acclamation; Gospel*)

The acclamation adapts Matthew 11:25 and performs what it says: the assembly blesses the Father and receives the Gospel as gift rather than mastery. "Little ones" does not canonize ignorance or forbid disciplined study. In context it contrasts receptive dependence with the self-securing posture that refuses Jesus' works and wisdom.

The Gospel's center is relational before it is therapeutic. The Son receives all from the Father; only Father and Son know one another in the unique manner expressed here; those to whom the Son reveals enter by gift. The invitation to the burdened follows this claim. Rest is communion under the revealing Son, not a technique detached from his identity.

The yoke image prevents an interpretation of rest as absence of claim. A yoke joins a learner to directed labor; Jesus

calls hearers to take and learn. Its goodness lies in the teacher's meek and humble heart and in the fittingness of his lordship. Christian meekness therefore cannot mean acquiescing in abuse or refusing duties of protection. It is strength governed by truth and charity under Christ.

Direct reception and its boundary

The repository-audited direct witnesses used here expound Romans 8, not Matthew 11 or the complete formulary. Chrysostom, Augustine, and Aquinas support Spirit-enabled mortification and filial life. The Gospel analysis is close exegesis governed by its literary context and the Church's teaching on the Kingdom; no patristic unanimity about every image is claimed.

Purification and heavenly conduct (*Prayer over Offerings*)

The Prayer over the Offerings moves from a dedicated oblation to purification and heavenly conduct. It does not identify the gifts with moral effort or make purification the congregation's purchase. God receives the Church's offering within Christ's action and is asked to transform those who offer. Because the prayer is common to A/B/C, relating it to the meek yoke is a later synthesis rather than a Lectionary claim.

Two Communion paths and one final petition (*Communion A; Communion B; Prayer after Communion*)

Communion Antiphon A appoints Psalm 34's invitation to taste and see within sacramental reception. Its full psalmic context joins tasting to blessing, seeking, deliverance, instruction, and refuge. It does not reduce Eucharistic truth to a pleasant feeling; objective gift and fitting disposition remain distinct.

Alternative B repeats Matthew 11:28 and gives this cycle a particularly transparent Gospel–Communion correspondence. On this path, the burdened hear the same invitation at proclamation and sacramental approach. The two appointed antiphons remain distinct alternatives, each with its own textual contribution.

The Prayer after Communion asks that recipients filled with great gifts receive salvation and continue in praise. Its order matters: divine gift precedes enduring response. "Unceasing" praise cannot mean continuous speech; it names a life ordered toward God, including work, rest, service, repentance, and the next Eucharistic gathering.

The Propers: Interpretive Possibilities

The following are original editorial and AI-generated possibilities. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities, claim no historical compositional intent, and remain bounded by the source distinctions stated in each proposal.

The yoke as the peaceful king's mode of rule. (*First Reading; Gospel*) Zechariah removes war's equipment; Jesus gives a yoke. One possible liturgical reading is that the Messiah does not abolish authority but converts its form: coercive mastery yields to a teaching relation whose burden is fitted by the meek King. The proposal is pastorally fruitful wherever "gentleness" is confused with aimlessness. Its limit is historical: Matthew 11 does not quote Zechariah 9 here, and the Lectionary's official correlation does not prove that the two authors intended this exact contrast.

From being bowed down to taking up a yoke. (*Responsorial Psalm; Gospel; Communion B*) Psalm 145 praises God who raises those bowed down; Matthew summons the burdened to take Christ's yoke; Communion B may repeat the summons. The movement may suggest that salvation is not simply removal of every weight but liberation from crushing mastery for fitting discipleship. This synthesis can guard against both Pelagian exertion and passive quietism. It must not imply that God wills abuse as a spiritual burden or that medical, legal, or protective relief should be refused.

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Celebration	Fourteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time; Sunday rank; green.
Formula	PC-S38-A; canonical Year A target; dated U.S. occurrence 2026-07-05.
Books	U.S. <i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> (implemented 2011), Week XIV owner; U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Second Typical Edition, Volume I, no. 100.
Calendar scope	General Roman Calendar as implemented for the United States; national scope.
Cycle	Sunday Year A.
Textual branches	Two Responsorial Psalm responses and two Communion Antiphons.

Branch Resolution

Branch ID	Authority and trigger	Status	Units affected	Resolution
psalm-response-textual	Lectionary 100	Appointed alternative	Textual response marked <i>cf.</i> Ps. 145:1	Documented, not selected
psalm-response-alleluia	Lectionary 100	Appointed alternative	<i>Alleluia</i> response to the same Psalm verses	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-psalm-34	Week XIV formulary	Appointed alternative	Communion Antiphon A	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-matthew-11	Week XIV formulary	Appointed alternative	Communion Antiphon B	Documented, not selected

Appendix: Scope and Qualifications

Formula. Lectionary 100, both Psalm responses, both Communion alternatives, and the Week XIV orations and antiphons were audited. **Historical study.** Every directly appointed scriptural passage and marked adaptation appears in canonical order, with Matthew’s composition separated from the narrated event. **Reception.** Repository-audited Chrysostom, Augustine, and Aquinas directly illuminate Romans 8; the Zechariah and Matthew commentary rests on textual context and identified doctrinal sources. **Rights.** Only citations, short incipits, and original summaries appear. **Outstanding.** 2008 page-image typography and layout, full U.S. altar-book English-oration collation, and independent theological review; this working guide is not publication-final. **Audit trail.** `instance/manifest.md`; `propers/verified.md`; `../shared/ordinary-time/weeks/14/propers/verified.md`; `research/scope.md`.

References

Liturgical and scriptural sources

- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (Vatican City, 2002), Week XIV, p. 464; the shared audit records exact owner evidence and the official 2008 variation-list result (Ordinary Time changes only at pp. 457 and 471; none at pp. 464–466).
- United States Conference of Catholic Bishops, *2026 Liturgical Calendar* and Lectionary 100 occurrence page, checked 2026-07-15.
- Bishops’ official *Antiphony*, p. 74, corroborating the ICEL antiphon assignments; protected wording is not reproduced.
- Holy See, *General Instruction of the Roman Missal*, especially 46–90; approved *General Introduction to the Lectionary*, especially 65–69, 78–91, and 93–110.
- Holy Scripture: Psalms 34, 48, and 145; Zechariah 9; Matthew 11; Romans 8. Historical orientation used the corresponding *New American Bible, Revised Edition* introductions, texts, and notes at Zechariah, Matthew, and Romans.

Reception and doctrinal illumination

- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 14 on Romans*, direct treatment of Romans 8:12–17, working English text.
- St. Augustine, *Sermon 156* §§6–15, direct treatment of Romans 8:12–17, Latin text.
- St. Thomas Aquinas, *Commentary on Romans VIII*, lect. 3, nos. 634–651, Latin and English.
- *Catechism of the Catholic Church* 541–550, the Kingdom present in Christ and disclosed in his ministry; doctrinal illumination, not direct commentary on the Week XIV formulary.

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (structural audit, document-revision, and production roles); Codex CLI 0.144.5; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (reader-order structural revision: moved and retitled the unchanged scriptural chronology and location sheet and set its page boundaries); Codex CLI 0.144.5; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (one-page scriptural dossier compaction and source-level fit-audit role); API workspace; unexposed: client version, interface, and server revision

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